LIBRARY

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E-mail: library@rhu.edu.lb
www.rhu.edu.lb/library

The Library at Rafik Hariri University supports students, faculty, and staff with the resources and services they need to succeed in their educational and research undertakings. The library was founded in 1999. The building occupies more than 650 square meters of space, offering users ample study and computing commons, halls for meetings, seminars, conferences, and classrooms. The library adheres to international standards and implements modern technologies across all functions and services. The RHU library provides academic programs with books, journals, and multimedia resources. It also has a modern IT infrastructure, which includes:

- An integrated library system, WMS (WorldShare Management Services)/ OCLC, that embeds all library functions, services, and auxiliary tools that can be accessed on and off campus.
- Workstations located in the reference area and connected to the Internet to access online catalogs, e-databases, Turnitin, and other resources
- A multimedia room equipped with state-of-the-art modern tools, computers, video projectors, data shows, CD writers, scanners, etc.
- Wireless connectivity covers all library spaces.

RHU continues to develop branding and library resources and services in response to changes and emergent needs, participates proactively in the enrichment of the educational experience, improves information technology and multimedia assets, repurposes available space to accommodate changing library roles, improves community outreach and branding, and improves administrative structure and commits to due process.

Information Resources

The RHU Library collections include a wide range of information resources to support all academic disciplines and meet the needs of university faculty and students. In addition to maintaining traditional printed resources, such as books and periodicals, the library holds a collection of electronic resources and multimedia materials (including open-access databases). The library home page provides links to full-text online databases, e-journals, e-books, research databases, and online catalogs. The homepage also includes information about library policies, service hours, auxiliary tools, and services. See https://rhu.edu.lb/Library.

Organization of Materials

Library resources are organized in accordance with international standards and best practices. All print resources are arranged and cataloged according to Dewey Decimal Classification 21 and MARC21 formats and standards for building bibliographic databases.

Library Services

The library staff assists users in using library resources and responds to inquiries received in person, by phone, by email, or through the library home page electronic forms. The staff also organizes specific training sessions to help users improve their skills in searching for and retrieving relevant information. Faculty, students, and staff with valid ID cards may borrow library materials in accordance with the circulation policy. Faculty members may request that books and other materials be placed on reserve for students to use within the library premises for a limited time. Computer commons provide users with on-site access to and retrieval of resources. Media resources, copiers, and printers are available inside the RHU Library. Prepaid cards may be purchased to use the printing and photocopying machines.

Also, to expand resources beyond those available on campus, improve services, and support research, the RHU Library joined the Interlibrary Loan Consortium and signed an agreement with the Baakline National Library. These agreements will facilitate resource sharing among libraries by supplying books, e-book chapters, articles, and other materials.

Interlibrary Loan

RHU students can borrow, free of charge, books, documents, and articles that are available in the libraries of the American University of Beirut, Beirut Arab University, Haigazian University, Lebanese American University, Middle East University, Notre Dame University-Louaize, United Nations - Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia, Université Saint-Esprit de Kaslik, Université Saint-Joseph de Beyrouth, and University of Balamand.

Baakline National Library

RHU students can visit the Baakline National Library and borrow books, documents, and articles free of charge.

Library Clearance

To obtain library clearance, all graduates must submit a soft copy of their senior projects in RHU Library format (Turabian format). Graduates should also ensure that all books and other borrowed materials are returned to the library before clearance.

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY DEPARTMENT

IT Helpdesk
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The Information Technology Department exists to provide optimal IT solutions to support the University students, faculty, and staff in their quest to achieve excellence in teaching, learning, research, and service. It actively engages the teaching and learning processes by introducing multimedia solutions and mobile technologies, creating a smart classroom environment, and supporting effective utilization of the learning management system.
The IT Department also supports the administrative divisions in adopting technologies that improve users' productivity in executing University functions and managing all University information systems. Additionally, the IT Department maintains and upgrades all hardware, software, and applications that support the University's academic and administrative functions. The IT Department also manages infrastructure planning and maintenance and supervises related projects.

Operation and Network Services

The IT Department runs a state-of-the-art Data Center that houses computers and related telecommunications and storage systems, including the latest-generation servers, Virtual Desktop Infrastructure, Storage Area Networking, and Intrusion Prevention System. The center operates redundant power sources, data communications connections, and security devices.

The center includes numerous servers that provide all students, faculty, and staff with storage space and privileged access to network-based data, software resources, and Internet and e-mail services.

The network serves all students, faculty, and staff. It covers over nine buildings of classrooms, offices, and student and faculty dorms. The Gigabit Ethernet fiber-optic backbone network is connected to the Internet via a 150 Mbps line to provide bandwidth for quality services. The network has over 840 voice/data points and 40 or more wireless access points covering all university buildings. At present, nearly 400 computers make up the University network.

Management Information System (MIS)

The Management Information Systems (MIS) Section includes a highly competent team that manages the University Information Systems. The MIS is responsible for developing, administering, supporting, and providing service management for the University Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP), including the Student Information System (CampusVue), student accounting, finance, payroll, human resources systems, library and archiving systems, staff work log system, and an ID card system. Furthermore, the

MIS manages information flow and generates reports for various university divisions to support planning and decision-making.

University Website

The RHU website is a vital communication platform for the University and a primary source of information for prospective and current students, faculty, staff, and other audiences. Managed via a responsive content management system (CMS) under the system administrator's supervision, the website ensures that all content is accurate, up to date, and easily accessible.

In addition to serving as an information hub, the RHU website provides users with a wide range of online services, including the Student Information System, Moodle, an Online Payment System, Surveys and Voting tools, an Alumni Section, the latest Press Releases, Events and News, Career opportunities, Downloadable Applications, and more.

Instructional and Classroom Technologies

A team of dedicated specialists provides technology-aided teaching that meets the learning needs of faculty and students. It maintains multimedia assets in more than 32 classrooms and intelligent classrooms. The team manages Moodle – a Learning Management System (LMS) - which provides the platform through which faculty and students actively engage with course material and improve students' ability to attain expected learning outcomes. New tools simplify the creation of online courses and enable the conversion of documents into dynamic objects.

IT Helpdesk Support Services

The IT Helpdesk team provides a wide range of support services for RHU students, faculty, and staff to ensure that technology-aided teaching, learning, and administrative processes run smoothly. These services include, but are not limited to, support for all IT peripherals (hardware and software) in offices, classrooms, and computer labs; user account management; e-mail services; internet and Wi-Fi services; file-sharing management; surveillance camera management; access control management; ID card printing; etc.

The Helpdesk team uses the Ticket Management System (TMS) as its primary communication channel with RHU faculty and staff. TMS provides a transparent and interactive platform for staff and faculty members to send and save requests (tickets) to report incidents and follow up on them. Also, TMS provides a space for end-users to provide satisfaction feedback on the service they receive from the ITC personnel in each ticket.

QUALITY ASSURANCE AND INSTITUTIONAL ADVANCEMENT

Ms. Mirna Talhouk, Associate Director
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Established in 2014, the Quality Assurance and Institutional Advancement (QAIA) Office plays a pivotal role in fostering a culture of excellence, accountability, and continuous improvement across the university. The office is dedicated to enhancing institutional effectiveness through evidence-based decision-making, strategic planning, and rigorous quality assurance practices.

QAIA serves as a central hub for collecting, analyzing, and utilizing institutional data to support academic and administrative units in achieving their goals. By aligning quality assurance efforts with institutional priorities, QAIA ensures consistency, transparency, and innovation in all aspects of university operations.

Core Functions

- **Institutional Research & Data Analytics**
  Design and implement surveys, focus groups, and assessment tools to gather and analyze data that informs strategic decisions.
- **Reporting & Insights**
  Develop comprehensive reports for university leadership to guide planning, policy development, and performance evaluation.
- **Institutional Effectiveness Coordination**
  Harmonize assessment activities across academic and administrative units to ensure alignment with institutional outcomes and standards.
- **Data Quality & Governance**
  Identify gaps in data collection and utilization and establish protocols to ensure data integrity and reliability.
- **Knowledge Management**
  Promote the effective use of internal and external assessment data to support continuous improvement and informed decision-making.
- **Evaluation & Assessment Frameworks**
  Design and update evaluation methodologies tailored to different program categories and validate development plans for quality assurance.
- **Accreditation Support**
  Provide guidance and resources to academic units in preparing for national and international accreditation processes.